



वस्त्र मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF
TEXTILES

EKTA



(Exhibition & Knowledge Sharing for Textile Advantage) in Ladakh

Dates : 30th June-4th July 2025

Venue: Eco Park, Leh City

Organized by: CWDB, Ministry of Textiles, GOI
& UT Administration of Ladakh





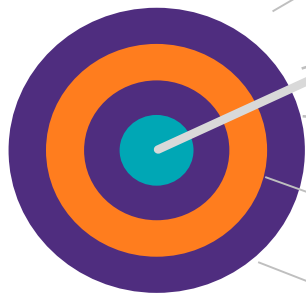
Context & Background

- Ladakh's unique textile tradition reflects its geography, culture, and climate – with Pashmina at its heart.
 - Traditional practices include hand-spun Pashmina, sheep & yak wool weaving, and natural dyeing rooted in Himalayan heritage.
 - Despite global recognition, these crafts face isolation from mainstream markets, innovation, and scalability.
 - EKTA is a strategic initiative under flagship schemes (PM-MITRA, Pashmina Development Scheme, Handloom & Handicraft Development) to integrate Ladakh's artisan ecosystem with modern value chains
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About EKTA

- EKTA stands for **Exhibition cum Knowledge Sharing for Textile Advantage**.
- Aims to **celebrate tradition, foster innovation, and empower artisans**.
- **Theme:** “From Loom to Lifestyle: A Future Woven with Tradition”

Objectives



01

- Showcase Pashmina, wool, silk, jute, handloom & tribal crafts.

02

- Build capacities in innovation, branding & digital marketing.

03

- Promote market access and entrepreneurship

04

- Ways to increase Pashmina Goat Population and Pashmina Wool Production

05

- Foster inter-regional collaboration and knowledge exchange

Participation & Exhibitions

- ❑ **Total Stalls:** 41
 - ❖ Wool: 20 | Jute: 3 | Silk: 2 | Handloom: 5 | Handicrafts: 5 | Entrepreneurs: 6
- ❑ **Key Participants:**
 - ❖ Artisans,
 - ❖ Entrepreneurs,
 - ❖ Changpa nomads
 - ❖ MSMEs,
 - ❖ SHGs
 - ❖ Government bodies (Officials from NJB, CSB, CWDB, DC Handlooms/Handicrafts, UT of Ladakh Administration Depts- Sheep Husbandry, Industries, Handloom)
- ❑ **Live Demonstrations**
 - ❖ Hand spinning of Pashmina Yarn and weaving of Pashmina Plain and Kani Shawl
 - ❖ Pashmina goat combing techniques,
 - ❖ Demonstration of portable tent with accessories (Gum Boot, Torch, etc) for nomads.
 - ❖ Predator Proof Coral with LED lights having Pashmina Goats.



Knowledge Sessions under EKTA

01

- Inaugural session

02

- Branding of pashmina Products through Pashmina Mark & its impacts
- Development of SOP and Execution of GI tag of raw Pashmina

03

- Ensuring Excellence: The role of quality assurance in the Production, processing and Marketing of Pashmina
- Entrepreneurship management for Pashmina value chain in India

04

- Scope and potential for Jute Diversified Products for Sustainable Development

05

- Himalayas to Horizons: reviving the Roots of Sericulture

06

- Steering Opportunities for artisans and weavers- Digital Marketing and leveraging GI

07

- Utilization of pashmina Guard hair for innovative products
- Presentation by Dept of Animal Husbandry, GOI
- Scope for increase in the production of Pashmina wool by sheep Husbandry, Leh and Animal Husbandry Dept.

Inaugural Session

Date 30th June 2025 Time 10 AM – 12:30 PM Location Eco Park, Leh city

Agenda

To mainstream isolated crafts and showcase local craft

Focus on increasing production, quality and export potential

Discussion Point

Emphasis on product selling, innovation, and buyer linkages

To provide advantages to SHGs and herders

Highlighting the need for skill enhancement, value addition and role of young entrepreneurs

Vision to make India a global textile superpower by 2030- Target: \$196 Bn to \$350 Bn

Signing and Exchange of MoU between CWDB and CSB

Scope of Agreement includes:

- To provide quality training in the area of sericulture and wool field
- To conduct sericulture and wool research in the area of mutual benefit to understand transfer of technologies and product development





Branding of Pashmina Products through Pashmina Mark and its Impacts (Textile Committee)

Date	30 th June 2025	Time	1:30 PM – 3:00 PM	Location	Eco Park, Leh City
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Discussion Points	Categories	Proposed fees (₹)
• Need for the Pashmina Mark ○ To distinguish genuine pashmina to counterfeits and create a collective brand for international market • Products to be covered ○ All pashmina products including fibres, yarn, fabric, and value-added products (to be identified during product mapping) • Development of Mark ○ Two labels are proposed - ○ 100% pure pashmina (different indicators for handspun and Machine spun) ○ Pashmina rich products (different ratios viz. 70:30, 80:20 etc.) • Surveillance & Marketing Promotion ○ Textile Committee and CWDB to carry out periodic verification of products of registered users at retail points ○ Sample collection and conformity assessment ○ Non-Conformity and cancellation of Registration ○ Data base creation and linking with different government platforms ○ Dedicated initiatives for brand promotion through different means ○ Linking to e-commerce platforms ONDC exclusively for registered users • Way Forward ○ Once launched, the initiative will help in branding and promotion of Pashmina wool in global market ○ Contains counterfeits and help in harvesting premium prices	Individual Entrepreneurs, Weavers, Artisans & SHGs	₹ 2,000
	Societies, Apex Co-Op Societies & handloom & handicraft development corporation, central/state government sponsored bodies	₹10,000
	Manufacturing units, manufacturers, Traders/Retailers (Domestic market), Merchant Exporter	

Execution of GI Tag of Raw Pashmina (Textile Committee)

Date 30th June 2025

Time 1:30 PM – 3:00 PM

Location Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

- **GI Tag**
 - A form of IPR linked to specific geography
 - Protects products with unique origin, quality and tradition
 - Pashmina received the Ladakh GI tag
- **Promotion for Effective Outcomes**
 - Exhibitions, visual merchandising
 - Product catalogue and showcasing GI-tagged goods
- **Export Readiness**
 - Training producers for export of GI-tagged goods
- **Traceability of GI Goods**
 - Mandatory registration for authenticity tracking
- Requirement of a **SOP** for capacity building, market linkages, stopping misuse of GI tag through regular inspection and creation of brand awareness



Ensuring Excellence: The Role of Quality Assurance in Production, Processing and Marketing of Pashmina (SKUAST)

Date

1st July 2025

Time

10 AM – 12:30 PM

Location

Eco Park, Leh city

Agenda

To discuss the role of quality assurance in Pashmina industry given that it supports global recognition, enhances consumer trust, and empowers artisans through premium quality production

Objectives of Quality Assurance in Production & Processing

- Ensure **authenticity** and certify genuine Pashmina
- Maintain product standards
- Enhance processing efficiency by adopting best practices
- Improve market competitiveness
- Meet global standards
- Promote artisan welfare

Objectives of Quality Assurance in Marketing

- Builds consumer trust and brand reputation
- Improves market competitiveness
- Enhances packaging and presentation
- Strengthens promotional messaging
- Preserves traditional value
- Ensures compliance for export markets

Challenges in Implementing Quality Assurance

- Limited testing facilities
- Presence of fake or blended products
- Lack of awareness among artisans
- High cost of certification
- Unorganized and fragmented supply chain
- Weak regulatory oversight
- Inconsistent processing techniques
- Limited market feedback mechanism
- Time consuming process

Way Forward

- Establishing accredited testing and certification labs
- Capacity building and training of artisans
- Promotion of certification and labelling
- Standardization of processing techniques
- Organize the supply chain
- Use of digital tools for traceability
- Create market linkages for certified products
- Policy and institutional support

Entrepreneurship Management for Pashmina Value Chain in India

— (NINFET)

Date 1st July 2025

Time 10:00 AM – 12:30 PM

Location Eco Park, Leh City

Agenda

To achieve excellency in manufacturing eco-friendly and sustainable pashmina garments using innovative processing technologies and diversified value-added products through research

Discussion Points

The discussion began with the four key stages of Pashmina value generation—Procurement, Processing, Transformation, and Labelling.

It further covered the theme of entrepreneurship development, highlighting its significance in rural empowerment and sustainable economic growth.

Key traits like risk-taking and forward-thinking were underscored as essential characteristics of successful entrepreneurs

Business Plan I – Innovating eco-friendly textiles for greater future

- Pashmina is biodegradable and traditionally used for shawls, however, the potential in apparel and fashion textile has not been explored
- Blend of high-quality pashmina with polyester, wool and nylon to create soft, durable and sustainable apparels and fashionable textiles

Business Plan II – Utilization of locally available natural resources for natural dyeing of silk and woolen yarn along with Pashmina fabric:

- Establishment of pilot plant for natural colour extraction and dyeing units
- Standardization of natural colour extraction and application process for small scale and medium scale woolen industry

Scope and Potential for Jute Diversified Products for Sustainable Development (NJB)

Date

1st July 2025

Time

1:30 PM – 3:00 PM

Location

Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

Jute Resource-Cum-Production Centres (JRCPC)

- Jute Centres to be set up in multiple clusters
- Training, Designing, Production, Raw Material & Market support
- Maximize participation of **women** (70% beneficiaries) through WSHGs
- Support **20** trainees/batch, maximum assistance of **INR 2.14 lakh** per cycle (35 days)
- Trainers from Kolkata
- **50%** subsidy on procurement of machinery for JRCPC (max INR 12,500/machine)
- Max support of **INR 12,000** for bio-metric, internet & maintenance

Jute Retail Outlet (JRO)

- Source at least **50%** of Jute Diversified Products (JDP) from Artisans, WSHGs, Micro/Small Units & beneficiaries of JRCPC
- **Forward linkage** & definite & sustained market support
- Registered jute entrepreneurs, NGOs, Cooperative Societies, PSUs, agencies engaged in product identification & marketing of JDPs at least for last 3 years & having at least 150 sq ft of space in market areas/tourist spots/shopping malls etc for running jute retail outlets
- Rate of assistance will be **25%** on actual sales on GST return. Max support capped at **INR 75,000/pm**

Domestic Market Promotion Activities (DMPA)

- Develop, promote, expand domestic markets
- **Selling & Marketing Platforms** – Fairs, Exhibitions, Roadshows
- Ensure sustained livelihood earnings for artisans
- **New diversified products** – speciality fine fabric, JGT & Jute Technical Textile, Industrial products, Hygiene products, composite boards etc

Day 2 Glimpse



Himalayas to Horizons: Reviving the Roots of Sericulture (CSB)

Date 2nd July 2025 Time 10:00 AM – 12:30 PM Location Eco Park, Leh City

Agenda

Innovations in Silk Blending

Discussion Points

- Central Silk Board (CSB) has initiated R&D efforts for revival and development of Sericulture in the Union Territory as there is enormous scope for reviving and establishing sericulture in the Union Territory of Ladakh through the Silk Samagra-2 scheme. Hence, the UT Administration is requested to designate a Nodal Department to implement Sericulture activities. The department will form a Project Monitoring Committee under Silk Samagra-2 and provide the beneficiary support for sericulture activities.
- Ministry of Textiles through CSB-CSR&TI Pampore has initiated temperate sericulture development efforts in the Leh and Kargil regions through 3-year full-fledged R&D project. This includes development of 5000 temperate mulberry trees and silkworm rearing demonstrations. Further, the State Agriculture Department and stakeholders were motivated for collaboration and development of Sericulture.
- During EKTA event at Leh, CSB signed an MoU with Central Wool Development Board (CWDB) for collaboration in training, R&D, extension, marketing and exchange of facilities and experts for silk-wool blend development. There is a scope for promoting silk-wool blending activities by involving Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and local women, thereby enhancing livelihood opportunities.
- CSB-CSR&TI, Pampore also signed an MoU with the University of Ladakh to collaborate on R&D for temperate sericulture, including setting up of a model farm and on-farm demonstrations in dry temperate conditions.
- Once sericulture is established, there will be significant potential for by-product utilization and value addition, such as the production of mulberry jam, wine, and pupal-based products etc
- The CSB Pavilion attracted a huge crowd, including foreign visitors and showcased all five varieties of silk and silk products. It served as an eye-opener for the public and inspired interest in taking up sericulture-based livelihoods.

Steering Opportunities for artisan and weavers- Digital Marketing and leveraging GI (DC HC & DC HL)

Date

2nd July 2025

Time

1:30 PM – 3:00 PM

Location

Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

1. Active support of Directorate of Industries , Govt. Of Ladakh is necessary for implementation of Development programs for welfare of artisans and weavers of the state.
 2. Artisans in Ladakh are scattered and in remote areas, therefore close coordination of field offices of Minstry of Textiles with Direcorate of Industries, Ladakh is necessary to extend benefits among artisans and weavers.
 3. Crafts of Ladakh requires more exposure in other States .
 4. Artisans and weavers of Ladakh should participate more and more in marketing events held outside Ladakh. Necessary support to artisans and weavers should be extended by State Govt. Ensuring maximum participation .
 5. There is a need to register more crafts under GI Act.
 6. Digital marketing platforms are great opportunities for artisans of Ladakh. However there is a need to create awareness and facilitate them to onboard on digital marketing platforms
 7. Ladakh is Rich in culture and traditions and agressive marketing of brand Ladakh for Handloom and handicrafts will open opportunities in both domestic and international market.
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Day 3 Glimpse



Utilization of Pashmina Guard hairs for innovative products (IJIRA)

Date 3rd July 2025 Time 10:00 AM – 12:30 PM Location Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

1. Current Production Landscape

- Total Wool Production (Ladakh Region): ~150–200 MT/year, Pashmina (Changthangi Goats): ~50–55 MT/year, Potential Dehaired Fine Pashmina: ~24.5–30.25 MT/year, Actual Marketed Output: ~9 MT/year
→ Over 70% of fine pashmina remains underutilized or is sold at low prices due to lack of infrastructure and organized systems.

2. Critical Gaps Identified

- No Processing Infrastructure for: Coarse wool (~200 MT/year), Pashmina guard hair (~10–15 MT/year discarded), Home-based, unorganized production system with limited scalability
- Absence of downstream value chains for: Technical textile applications, High-value woolen blends, Product diversification (insulation, composites, apparel)

Actions Required:

A. Enabling Framework for Scale & Fairness

- Tripartite Agreement between LAHDC, Govt. of Ladakh, and relevant central agencies
- Fair Procurement Price Fixation: Recommend ₹80/kg (comparable to PET-based material rates)
- Subsidy and/or Price Stabilization Mechanism to ensure equitable returns and steady supply

B. Roadmap for Implementation

- Pilot-scale Processing Unit at IJIRA to demonstrate feasibility and establish scale
- Product Performance Evaluation: Collaborative testing by IJIRA, LAHDC, and local bodies
- Training & Capacity Building: IJIRA to prepare implementation dossiers for pastoralists and stakeholders
- Policy & Market Linkage Facilitation:
 - Strategic partnerships with CWDB, NJB, NTTM, Army, and national research/industry bodies

Presentation by Dept of Animal Husbandry Govt. of India (Joint — Commissioner, NLM)

Date 3rd July 2025 Time 10:00 AM – 12:30 PM Location Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

There is a need-

- to encourage young entrepreneurs by providing incentives, marketing linkages, branding
- mixing of traditional practices and modern scientific techniques , making it a economically viable business model
- good shelter, saving from inclement weather and predators
- breed improvements by selective breeding, inducting quality males, importing germplasm
- trainings and awareness
- quality nutrition, supplements for growth and lower kid mortality

DAHD support

A). under NLM- NLM-EDP- with 50 % capital subsidy, for establishing goat units , housing, animal procurement etc- silage, hay , TMR plants with 50 % subsidy under NLM-EDP- rejuvenating pastures , with 100 % subsidy,- .Fodder production from wasteland, rangeland, community land and degraded forestland

B). AHIDF with 3 % interest subvention, for establishing feed plants, silage plants, value addition and wool processing plants

C). health care support under - LHDCP for FMD and brucella vaccination, -PPR vaccine . Other vaccines , nutrition support and deworming under ASCAD

Scope for Increase in the production of Pashmina wool by Sheep Husbandry, Leh and Ministry of Animal Husbandry (Director Sheep Husbandry)

Date 3rd July 2025 Time 10:00 AM – 12:30 PM Location Eco Park, Leh City

Discussion Points

- **Health coverage:** CCPP disease affecting pashmina goats was discussed and JC, LNM instructed Sheep Husbandry Department, Ut Ladakh submit proposal so that funds under ASCARD scheme of NLM could be provisioned when new plan will be formulated.
- **Training:** lack of training and capacity building program for veterinary doctors, para-staff and nomads, or breeders was discussed and the Joint commissioners, NLM directed the Sheep Husbandry Department, UT Ladakh to submit proposal to reflect in the next plan.
- **Infrastructure:** The livestock shed enclosure made of chain link fencing required for shelter of pashmina goats to protect them from wild and stray dog depredation was discussed and requested the MOT, GOI, to provision under IWDP in the next plan.
- **Exposure tour of the nomads:** the nomads due to lack of sensitization for upgradation of their rearing practices, new generation showing reluctant to adopt the legacy of traditional livestock rearing. In order to sensitize them about the economic potential inherent in the pashmina business, exposure tour to Mongolia need to be provisioned for the same under NLM scheme.
- **Sheep and goat manure:** Sheep and goat manure is considered as high valued organic manure. However due to lack of its economic potential, it is selling at throw away price. The matter was discussed during the event and Joint commissioner instructed the SHD, UT Ladakh to submit a proposal under NLM

Day 4 Glimpse



Thank You

